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FRAMEWORK 02

SEPTEMBER 2026

ORIGINAL FRAMEWORK SERIES

IDEAS
INSIGHTS
IMPACT

FROM DISTRIBUTION
TO DESIRE

ENGINEERING CONSUMER PULL

THE SIX-GATE RETAIL
CONVERSION ARCHITECTURE

PRESENCE • SALIENCE • MEANING
TRUST • CHOICE • REPEAT

A practical and field-tested commercial framework to turn distribution and visibility into consumer pull, volume velocity and sustainable category leadership.

PEOPLE
PRODUCTS
PARTNERSHIPS
PROGRESS



MORE
DEMAND



STRONGER
BRANDS



HIGHER
VELOCITY



LASTING
LEADERSHIP

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COMMERCIAL IDEAS
FOR A STRONGER TOMORROW

01 The Conversion Gap

Why distribution alone does not create category pull

THE PROBLEM

Many commercial systems celebrate listing, distribution and shelf presence as if they were the final outcome. They are not. A product can be available in hundreds of outlets and still remain commercially weak if shoppers do not notice it, understand it, trust it, choose it and return to it.

The framework reframes retail growth as six gates.

01 PRESENCE

The product must be physically obtainable where target shoppers naturally buy.

02 SALIENCE

The product must earn attention inside a visually crowded buying environment.

03 MEANING

The shopper must quickly understand what the product is, why it matters and for whom.

04 TRUST

The shopper must feel enough confidence in quality, brand, value and purchase risk.

05 CHOICE

The final act of buying must feel easy, justified and friction-light.

06 REPEAT

The experience must create enough satisfaction and memory to support repurchase.

KEY IDEA

A weak result at any one gate constrains the value created by all the gates before it. Commercial conversion behaves more like a chain of multipliers than a checklist of independent activities.

02 The Six-Gate Architecture

A shopper must progress through the gates in sequence



THE LOOP

Repeat does not end the system. Repeat improves retailer confidence, shelf continuity, word-of-mouth and brand memory. Those effects strengthen future Presence and Salience, creating a commercial feedback loop.

03 Gate-by-Gate Diagnostic

The manager should identify the first gate that is leaking conversion

PRESENCE

Numeric distribution, on-shelf availability, stock cover

Is the shopper able to buy?

SALIENCE

Display share, eye-level exposure, POS visibility

Will the shopper notice?

MEANING

Message clarity, pack comprehension, use-case recognition

Will the shopper understand?

TRUST

Brand confidence, perceived value, proof cues, retailer endorsement

Will the shopper believe?

CHOICE

Trial rate, promo dependency, price friction, basket fit

Will the shopper act?

REPEAT

Repurchase rate, complaint rate, satisfaction, habitual re-entry

Will the shopper return?

MANAGERIAL RULE

Do not solve a Gate 2 problem with a Gate 5 discount. If shoppers are not seeing the product, lowering the price may destroy margin without repairing the actual conversion leak.

04 The Conversion Multiplier

A compact way to measure where growth is being lost

CORE EXPRESSION

$$CP = P \times S \times M \times T \times C \times R$$

Each factor is scored from 0.00 to 1.00. CP = Conversion Potential.

P PRESENCE

physical availability

S SALIENCE

attention strength

M MEANING

message clarity

T TRUST

confidence

C CHOICE

purchase ease

R REPEAT

repurchase strength

Why multiplication instead of addition?

Because a near-zero gate can collapse the commercial outcome even when other activities are strong. A beautifully displayed product that is frequently out of stock fails at Presence. A widely distributed product with confusing pack communication fails at Meaning. Multiplication makes the

ILLUSTRATIVE SCORE

$$0.90 \times 0.55 \times 0.75 \times 0.80 \times 0.70 \times 0.65 = 0.135$$

Strong distribution, but weak salience leaves only 13.5% of theoretical conversion potential.

05 Illustrative FMCG Application

How the framework changes the manager's next move

Scenario

A beverage SKU is listed in a large retail chain. Stock availability is good, price is competitive and the product has sufficient gross margin. Sales remain below expectation.

1

Presence = strong

Stores are stocked and replenishment is stable. Do not expand distribution first.

2

Salience = weak

The product sits low on shelf, has limited blocking and is visually dominated by larger brands.

3

Meaning = moderate

The pack communicates flavour but not a sharp consumption occasion or reason to switch.

4

Trust = adequate

Brand and quality are not the main barrier.

5

Choice = fragile

A price cut can generate trial, but the shopper still has little reason to notice the item.

6

Repeat = unknown

Low trial volume makes repeat data statistically weak.

RECOMMENDED RESPONSE

Repair Gate 2 before spending heavily on Gate 5. Improve shelf blocking, secondary visibility and visual interruption; then sharpen the pack or POS message around a clear consumption job. Use promotion as an accelerator after noticeability improves - not as a substitute for it.

06 The 30-Day Manager Playbook

A practical deployment sequence for one priority SKU or category

WEEK 1

MAP

Score all six gates using available sales, distribution, merchandising and consumer evidence.

WEEK 2

FIX

Choose the earliest weak gate and implement no more than three focused interventions.

WEEK 3

PROVE

Track leading indicators at the repaired gate before judging total sales impact.

WEEK 4

SCALE

If the gate improves and downstream conversion follows, replicate the intervention across comparable outlets.

Three discipline rules

- 01 Diagnose before discounting.
- 02 Improve the first weak gate, not the loudest symptom.
- 03 Scale only after evidence shows the repaired gate is moving downstream behaviour.

Distribution puts the product in the market. Conversion earns the shopper.

The Six-Gate Retail Conversion Architecture is designed to help commercial teams move beyond a simple “more outlets, more promotion” mindset. It treats consumer pull as a sequence of behavioural gates and gives managers a disciplined way to identify where commercial energy is being lost.

FRAMEWORK PRINCIPLE

“The job of retail execution is not merely to place a product in front of a shopper. It is to remove, one gate at a time, the reasons that prevent the shopper from choosing it again.”

CONCEPT & FRAMEWORK

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Framework 02 • September 2026 • Commercial Strategy Series

Authorship note: this document was freshly drafted as an original working framework for Mehedi Alim Ayon. No passages were copied from a third-party source. Independent similarity with existing ideas or terminology cannot be ruled out.